

appropriate disinfection measures. As stated however, both methods of this detection requires large amount of system resources.

One of the most reliable anti-virus solutions available is AVG Free. It's divided into three sections: Overview, Computer Scanner and Update Now. Overview provides info on the version running, last scan performed and the last definitions update. It also showcases all the option available like Link Scanner, E-mail Scanner, etc. and easily indicates whether they are up-to date (green) or outdated (red) along with their active status. If outdated, clicking on an option provides solutions.

Computer Scanner allows you to edit scan settings for the entire computer or specific folders and files. Scan settings let you determine scan access priority (fast, automatic or slow), the use of heuristics, automatically healing/removing infections and more. Scans can be also scheduled to run at specific times, on start-up or even after every few hours.

The Update Now section is the most straightforward tab. It automatically connects online to fetch the latest virus database definitions for detecting matching virus signatures.

For more options, click on **Tools > Advanced settings**. You can schedule scans for different components on the basis of frequency, time of day and what not. You can also determine update priorities, proxy settings, types of file extensions to be detected by the Resident Shield, etc.

On short notice at any time, free anti-virus scans are also available online through several reliable sites such as:

- <http://www.kaspersky.com/virusscanner>
- <http://security.symantec.com>
- <http://us.mcafee.com/root/mfs/scan.asp?affid=56>
- <http://www.bitdefender.com/scan8>
- <http://onecare.live.com/site/en-us/default.htm>
- <http://ca.com/securityadvisor/virusinfo/scan.aspx>
- <http://www.ewido.net/en/onlinecan>
- <http://www.pandasecurity.com/homeusers/solutions/activescan>

Some essential tips to preventing virus infections: Always scan external media. Schedule daily scans and updates (at the minimum). Never ever execute files from unknown email senders or follow unfamiliar links.